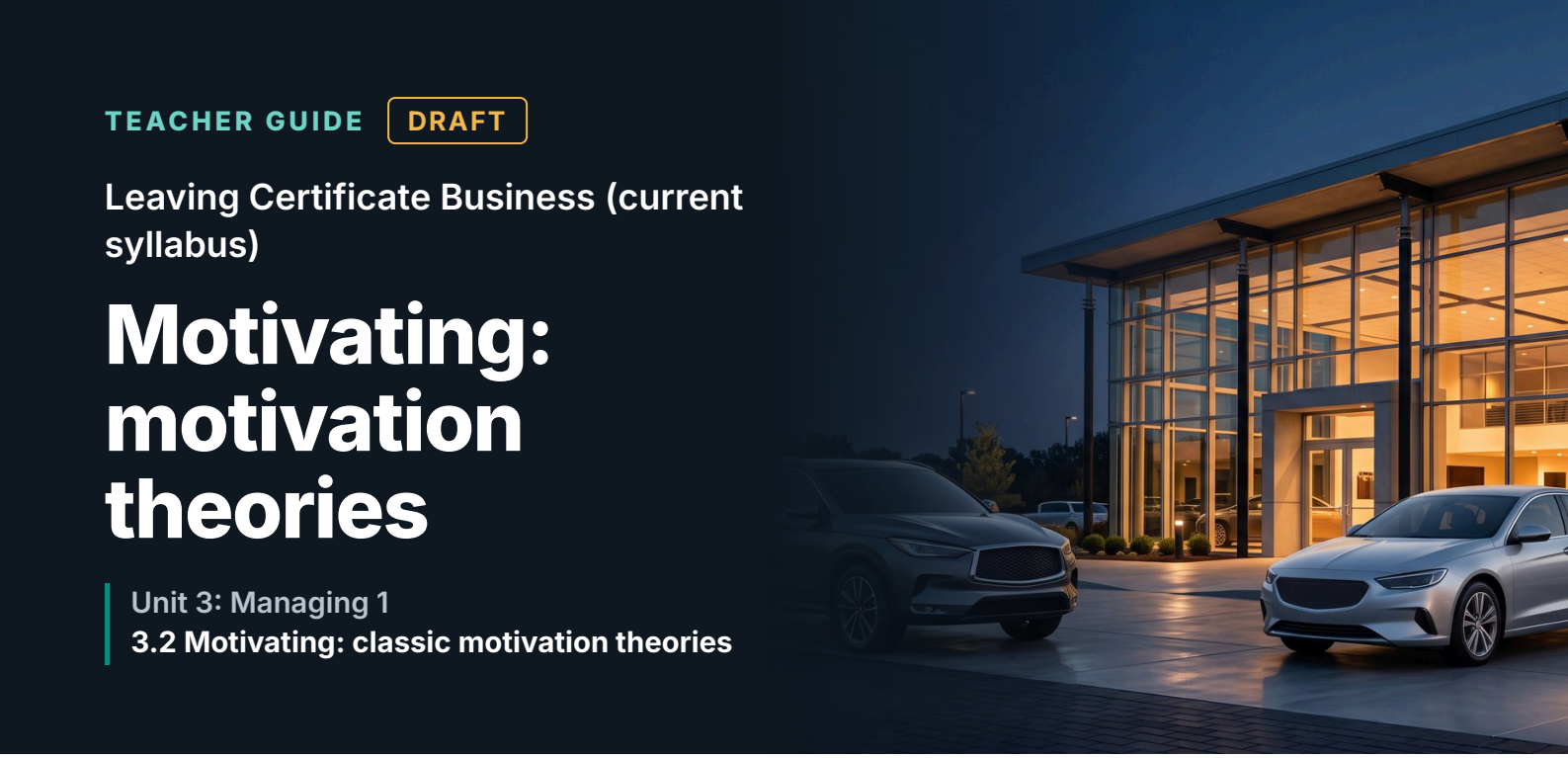
TEACHER GUIDE DRAFT

Leaving Certificate Business (current syllabus)

Motivating: motivation theories

Unit 3: Managing 1
3.2 Motivating: classic motivation theories



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise motivating: motivation theories on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min | **45 min** | 60 min | 75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same.

1 Piece rate faults

Round 1

You pay prep staff per car finished, not by the hour. Faults found at handover double.

What best explains the rise in faults?

- **A** Staff want more fringe benefits
- **B** Pay now rewards speed over quality
- **C** Staff have too little to do
- **D** Staff now earn less than before

ANSWER

✓ Pay now rewards speed over quality

Why: Paying per car rewards speed, so staff rush and quality falls.

2 Staff feel ignored

Round 1

A staff survey says pay is fine, but staff feel ignored.

Which two changes should motivate most?

- **A** Closer checks on their work
- **B** Let teams plan their own work
- **C** A bonus for every car sold
- **D** A 2% pay rise for all
- **E** Ask staff to help set targets

ANSWER

✓ Let teams plan their own work
✓ Ask staff to help set targets

Why: Feeling ignored is not about pay: involvement and trust tackle it.

3 Maslow in order

Round 2

Maslow's hierarchy of needs, at your firm.

Put the needs in order, lowest first?

- **A** Esteem: praise for good work
- **B** Social: a friendly team
- **C** Physiological: pay for the basics
- **D** Safety: a secure contract

ANSWER

1. **Physiological: pay for the basics**
2. **Safety: a secure contract**
3. **Social: a friendly team**
4. **Esteem: praise for good work**

Why: Maslow: physiological, safety, social, then esteem, then self-actualisation.

Topic tasks

4 Piece-rate pay

Round 2

Prep staff are paid per car finished.

Her pay this week?

Pay per car prepared	**€16**
Cars she prepared this week	**46 cars**
Extra per car above 30 cars	**€5**

ANSWER

€816

46 × €16 + 16 × €5 = €816

Why: Piece rate pays for output, so staff work faster, sometimes at the cost of quality.

5 Pay or promotion

Round 3

Sales staff are leaving. Exit interviews say pay is fair, but there is no chance to progress.

What should you offer, and why?

A Training and a clear promotion path

B A higher basic salary

ANSWER

✓ Training and a clear promotion path

Why: Pay is not the problem; a chance to grow and progress meets the need staff named.

6 Maslow: next need

Round 3

A technician has a secure, well-paid job and friends at work, but feels no one values her skill.

Using Maslow, which need should you meet next?

A Esteem needs

B Social needs

C Physiological needs

D Safety needs

ANSWER

✓ Esteem needs

Why: Safety and social needs are met; recognition is an esteem need, which comes next.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions. Pick the question topic “Motivating: motivation theories”: the 6 come from these 10 questions.

1 In Maslow’s hierarchy, which need is met by a secure job with regular pay?
✔ **Safety (security) needs**

2 A technician is well paid and respected but bored. Which Maslow level is unmet?
✔ **Self-actualisation**

3 A manager who follows McGregor’s Theory X believes that workers...
✔ **dislike work and must be closely controlled**

4 Which action fits a Theory Y approach to staff?
✔ **Giving technicians a say in how work is organised**

5 A salesperson earns €2,000 a month plus 1.5% commission on €80,000 of sales. What is the total pay?
✔ **€3,200**

6 A bonus of €150 is paid for each car above 10 sold in a month. A salesperson sells 16. What is the bonus?
✔ **€900**

7 A dealer offers only cash bonuses, but staff still leave. Which idea from Maslow explains this?
✔ **Higher needs like esteem and belonging are unmet**

8 Which is a non-financial motivator?
✔ **Praise from the manager**

9 Why does a dealer care about staff motivation?
✔ **Motivated staff sell more and stay longer**

10 Mechanics are given responsibility for whole jobs instead of single tasks. Which approach is this?
✔ **Job enrichment**